STUDY AID · MATTHEW 26:30-46 · EPISODE 52 (#55 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)

Watch *and Pray*

Where the flesh fails, prayer succeeds

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 26:30-46 in the LSB | 26:01 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The Lesson Everyone MISSED At Jesus' Arrest. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 26:30-46. After the hymn they go to the Mount of Olives. Jesus says they will all fall away, quoting 'I will strike down the shepherd,' but after He is raised He will go ahead of them to Galilee. Peter insists he will never fall away and will die with Jesus; all the disciples say the same. In Gethsemane Jesus takes Peter, James and John, says His soul is deeply grieved to the point of death, and prays three times, 'let this cup pass from Me; yet not as I will, but as You will.' Three times He finds them sleeping.
- Mark, Luke and John record these events slightly differently. 'You will all fall away' uses skandalizō, the word of Jesus' warning in 11:6. Jesus says 'I have been raised' (26:32), though elsewhere He says He will raise up the sanctuary of His body (John 2:19-21).
- Gethsemane means 'oil press.' Jesus separates to be alone with the Father. His human inclination to avoid the cup of wrath gives way at once to the Father's will. Jesus shows the spirit's victory over the flesh; the disciples, who had just vowed to die for Him, show the flesh's victory over the spirit.
- Connections: Zechariah 13:7 ('Strike the Shepherd'); the refrains of Psalms 42-43 ('Why are you in despair, O my soul?'), which end in joy at the altar of God (43:4); the Passover 'night to be kept' (Exodus 12:42); the cup of wrath (Isaiah 51:17; Ezekiel 23:33). Jesus' prayer echoes the Lord's Prayer (6:9-13): Father, Your will be done, deliver us, do not lead us into temptation.

> *"The victory of the Christian in moments of testing and temptation trades on persistent intentional prayer to their heavenly father.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"The disciples are displaying what it looks like for the flesh to have victory over the spirit.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- The lesson: the victory of the Christian in moments of testing and temptation trades on persistent, intentional prayer to their heavenly Father. Peter and Paul passed it on (1 Peter 5:8-9; Ephesians 6:18; 1 Corinthians 10:12-13).

Compare the prayers

Set Jesus' prayer in Gethsemane beside the prayer He taught (Matthew 6:9-13) and list the parts they share.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 52 of the Matthew study (playlist item 55).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 26:30-46 and turns to Mark 14, Luke 22, John 2 and 13, Zechariah 13, Matthew 6 and 11, Psalms 42-43, Isaiah 38 and 51, Exodus 12, Ezekiel 23, 1 Peter 5, Ephesians 6 and 1 Corinthians 10. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 26:30-46
Read in full: the warning and Gethsemane.

Mark 14:26-42
Mark's account.

Luke 22:31-46
Luke's account.

John 13:36-38
Peter's denial foretold.

Zechariah 13:7
Strike the Shepherd.

Matthew 11:2-6
Blessed is he who does not take offense at Me.

John 2:19-21
I will raise it up.

Psalm 42:1-11
Why are you in despair, O my soul?

Psalm 43:1-5
To God my exceeding joy.

Exodus 12:42
A night to be kept for Yahweh.

Isaiah 51:17
The cup of His wrath.

Ezekiel 23:33
The cup of horror and desolation.

Matthew 6:9-13

1 Peter 5:8-9

The Lord's Prayer.

Be watchful.

Ephesians 6:18
Praying at all times.

1 Corinthians 10:12-13
The way of escape.

Key verses in the LSB

"Keep watching and praying that you may not enter into temptation; the spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak."
Matthew 26:41 (LSB)

"My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me; yet not as I will, but as You will."
Matthew 26:39 (LSB)

"No temptation has overtaken you but such as is common to man, but God is faithful, who will not allow you to be tempted beyond what you are able, but with the temptation will provide the way of escape also, so that you will be able to endure it."
1 Corinthians 10:13 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Strike the Shepherd

The warning on the Mount of Olives and Peter's vow.



MATTHEW 26:31-32; ZECHARIAH 13:7

Strike the Shepherd

JESUS · MATTHEW 26:31
"Then Jesus *said to them, "You will all fall away because of Me this night, for it is written, 'I will strike down the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock shall be scattered.'"

ZECHARIAH · ZECHARIAH 13:7
""Awake, O sword, against My Shepherd / And against the man, My Associate," / Declares Yahweh of hosts. / "Strike the Shepherd that the sheep may be scattered; / And I will turn My hand against the little ones."

FROM THE VIDEO 'Fall away' is a form of skandalizō, the word of Jesus' warning to John's disciples: 'blessed is he who does not take offense at Me' (11:6). The disciples will do the very thing He warned against. Matthew 11:6

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus speaks of 'after I have been raised' (26:32); in John He says He will raise up the sanctuary of His body (John 2:19-21; 10:18). Both descriptions of the resurrection stand. John 2:19-21 John 10:18

◆ Factbook: Zechariah (father of John the Baptist) ◆ Factbook: Shepherd ◆ Factbook: Resurrection ◆ Factbook: Galilee

MATTHEW 26:33-35

'I will never fall away'

MATTHEW 26:34-35 (LSB)

ALL SAID THE SAME

“Jesus said to him, “Truly I say to you that this very night, before a rooster crows, you will deny Me three times.” Peter *said to Him, “Even if I have to die with You, I will not deny You.” All the disciples said the same thing too.”

FROM THE VIDEO The disciples say nothing about His death and resurrection; only Peter answers, bothered by the claim that they will fall away. And it is not just Peter: all of them say they are ready to die. Or so they thought.

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Factbook: Disciples

> *“The disciples are displaying what it looks like for the flesh to have victory over the spirit.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Gethsemane

The oil press, a soul deeply grieved, and a night of watching.

MATTHEW 26:36-38

The oil press

MATTHEW 26:36-38 (LSB)

GETHSEMANE

“Then Jesus *came with them to a place called Gethsemane, and *said to His disciples, “Sit here while I go over there and pray.” And He took with Him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and began to be grieved and distressed. Then He *said to them, “My soul is deeply grieved, to the point of death; remain here and keep watch with Me.””

FROM THE VIDEO Gethsemane means 'oil press'; a commentator the video cites places it in an olive grove on the western slope of the Mount of Olives.

FROM THE VIDEO When many would want people around them, Jesus goes to be alone with the Father. No one else has taken on the sins of the whole world in death.

◆ Factbook: Gethsemane ◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives ◆ Factbook: Prayer

PSALMS 42-43

Why are you in despair, O my soul?

THE PSALMIST · PSALM 42:5

“Why are you in despair, O my soul? / And why are you disturbed within me? / Wait for God, for I shall

THE PSALMIST · PSALM 43:4

“Then I will go to the altar of God, / To God my exceeding joy; / And upon the lyre I shall praise You,

still praise Him, / For the salvation of His presence.”

O God, my God.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'Deeply grieved' recalls the three refrains of Psalms 42-43 (42:5, 11; 43:5), where despair turns to joy. The video suggests the three refrains may parallel the temple's outer court, holy place and holy of holies, drawing nearer to God's presence.

Psalm 42:11 | Psalm 43:5

FROM THE VIDEO It also points to Isaiah 38:1, where Hezekiah 'became ill to the point of death.' Isaiah 38:1

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms ◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

EXODUS 12:42

Keep watch with Me

🌙 EXODUS 12:42 (LSB)

A NIGHT TO BE KEPT

“It is a night to be kept for Yahweh for having brought them out from the land of Egypt; this night is for Yahweh, to be kept by all the sons of Israel throughout their generations.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'Keep watch with Me' may be a call to observe leil shimmurim, 'the night of watching,' which Jews kept on Passover night to remember the Lord's protection in Egypt.

◆ Factbook: Passover ◆ Factbook: The Exodus



Remain here and keep watch with Me

James Tissot, The Grotto of the Agony, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“The flesh will fail in moments of testing and temptation. But where the flesh fails, prayer succeeds.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The cup

The cup of wrath, the Lord's Prayer, and the way of escape.



MATTHEW 26:39; ISAIAH 51:17

The cup of His wrath

JESUS · MATTHEW 26:39

“And He went a little beyond them, and fell on His face and prayed, saying, “My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me; yet not as I will, but as You will.””

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 51:17

“Awaken yourself! Awaken yourself! Arise, O Jerusalem, / You who have drunk from the hand of Yahweh the cup of His wrath; / The chalice of reeling you have drained to the dregs.”

FROM THE VIDEO In the Old Testament the cup means suffering and the wrath of God; Ezekiel speaks of 'the cup of horror and desolation' (Ezekiel 23:33). Ezekiel 23:33

FROM THE VIDEO Scholars call this Jesus' human temptability: an inclination to avoid the wrath, immediately surrendered to the Father's will, three times.

◆ Factbook: Cup ◆ Factbook: Isaiah ◆ Factbook: Ezekiel (prophet)



MATTHEW 6:9-13; 26:41

The Lord's Prayer in Gethsemane

MATTHEW 6:9-10 (LSB)

YOUR WILL BE DONE

““Pray, then, in this way: / ‘Our Father who is in heaven, / Hallowed be Your name. / Your kingdom come. / Your will be done, / On earth as it is in heaven.”

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus' prayer has three elements of the prayer He taught: an address to God as Father, a request for deliverance, and submission to His will. 'Keep watching and praying that you may not enter into temptation' matches 'do not lead us into temptation' (6:13). Matthew 6:13 Matthew 26:41

FROM THE VIDEO Both Jesus and the disciples face temptation; where they fail, He succeeds. They let their guard down.

◆ Factbook: Prayer



1 PETER 5:8-9; EPHESIANS 6:18

They got the message

PETER · 1 PETER 5:8

“Be of sober spirit, be watchful. Your adversary, the devil, prowls around like a roaring lion, seeking someone to devour.”

PAUL · EPHESIANS 6:18

“praying at all times with all prayer and petition in the Spirit, and to this end, being on the alert with all perseverance and petition for all the saints,”

FROM THE VIDEO The disciples went on to give the same warning. Paul adds that God 'will provide the way of escape also' (1 Corinthians 10:13); Jesus shows that the way of escape centers on prayer. 1 Corinthians 10:13

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Factbook: Paul ◆ Factbook: Satan



Let this cup pass from Me

Giovanni Bellini, The Agony in the Garden, c. 1458-1460. National Gallery, London, via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"Jesus shows the disciples that the way of escape centers on diligent prayer.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 26:30-46

What the video says, then a short background note.

Peter

VIDEO Vows never to fall away and to die with Jesus.

BACKGROUND Luke adds that Jesus prayed for Peter's faith (Luke 22:32).

Matthew 26:33-35 | Luke 22:31-32

◆ Peter (Simon Peter)

The two sons of Zebedee

VIDEO James and John, taken with Peter deeper into the garden.

BACKGROUND They had said they could drink His cup (20:22).

Matthew 26:37 | Matthew 20:22

The disciples

VIDEO All vow to die with Him; all fall asleep.

BACKGROUND 'Their eyes were heavy' (26:43).

Matthew 26:35 | Matthew 26:43 | ◆ Disciples

Hezekiah

VIDEO Ill 'to the point of death' in Isaiah 38:1.

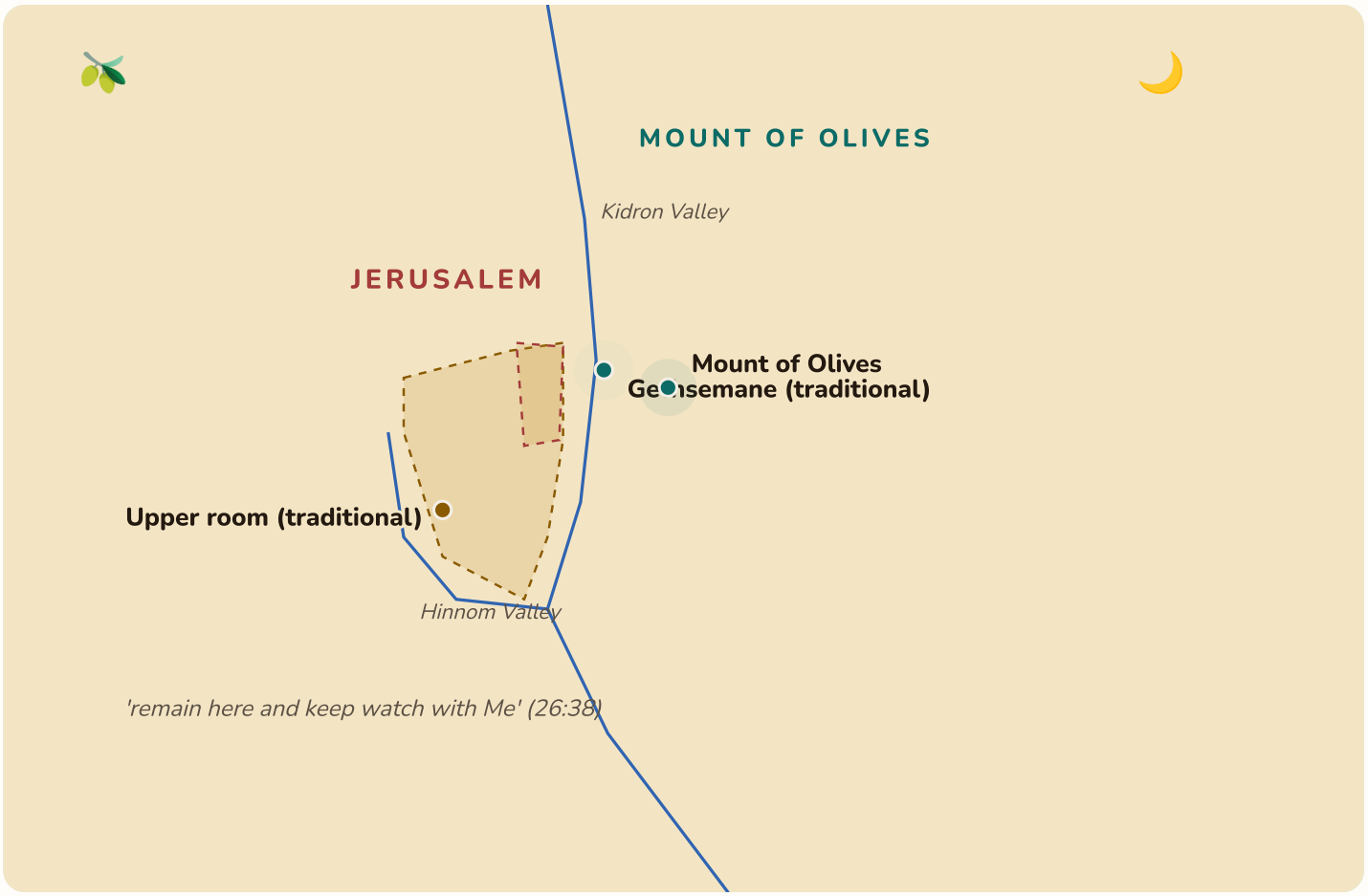
BACKGROUND King of Judah who prayed and was given fifteen more years (Isaiah 38:5).

Isaiah 38:1-5

07 · BACKGROUND

From the city to the garden

The pin outlined in the video's color is a place the video points to. Gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background

Schematic: drawn for this study from known sites. Walls (gold dashes) and the temple platform (coral dashes) are approximate for the first century. Traditional sites are marked as traditional.

Upper room (traditional) BACKGROUND
Where they sang the hymn before going out (26:30).

Gethsemane (traditional) VIDEO
'A place called Gethsemane' (26:36), the oil press.

◆ Factbook: Gethsemane

Mount of Olives VIDEO
'They went out to the Mount of Olives' (26:30).

◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives

08

Key terms

Gethsemane
VIDEO
'Oil press': an olive grove at the Mount of Olives.

Skandalizō
VIDEO
To cause to stumble or fall away; to take offense.

◆ Factbook: Gethsemane

Leil shimmurim

VIDEO

'Night of watching': Passover night kept for the Lord (Exodus 12:42).

◆ Factbook: Passover

The cup

VIDEO

An Old Testament image of suffering and of God's wrath.

◆ Factbook: Cup

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

σκανδαλίζω

skandalizō G4624

To cause to stumble; passive, to fall away, take offense.

Greek · Matt 26:31

Γεθσημανί

Gethsēmani G1068

Gethsemane, 'oil press.'

Greek · Matt 26:36

◆ Factbook: Gethsemane

περίλυπος

perilypos G4036

Deeply grieved, very sorrowful.

Greek · Matt 26:38

γρηγορέω

grēgoreō G1127

To keep awake, watch, be alert.

Greek · Matt 26:38, 41

πειρασμός

peirasmos G3986

Testing, temptation.

Greek · Matt 26:41

◆ Factbook: Temptation

πρόθυμος

prothymos G4289

Willing, eager, ready.

Greek · Matt 26:41

שִׁמֻּרִים

shimmurim H8107

Watching, vigil: 'a night to be kept.'

Hebrew · Exod 12:42

עוּר

'ur H5782

To rouse oneself, awake.

Hebrew · Zech 13:7; Isa 51:17

חֵמָה

chemah H2534

Heat, rage, wrath. Look up: BDB, חֵמָה.

Hebrew · Isa 51:17

◆ Factbook: Wrath of God

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Gethsemane

Olive groves covered the Mount of Olives, and presses crushed the olives for oil. The traditional site lies across the Kidron Valley from the temple, beside today's Church of All Nations.

Passover night

The Passover meal ran late into the night, and Jerusalem was crowded with pilgrims. Jesus' group would have walked down through the Kidron Valley to reach the Mount of Olives.

Praying three times

Praying the same prayer repeatedly was familiar in Israel; Daniel prayed three times a day (Daniel 6:10), and Paul asked three times for his thorn to be removed (2 Corinthians 12:8).

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *"For they who are desiring to die with Him, were not then able so much as to sorrow with Him wakefully, but sleep overcame them.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 83, on 26:40. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *"For where he should have prayed, and have said, Help us, that we be not cut off, he is confident in himself, and says, Though all men should be offended in You, yet will I never; though all should undergo this, I shall not undergo it, which led him*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 82, on 26:33. NPNF 1.10 (public domain); the sentence continues.

DEBATED **Where scholars differ**

What was the cup?

Most read the cup as God's wrath against sin, borne by Jesus. Others stress suffering and death in general. The previous episode noted a reading tied to the fourth Passover cup.

Jesus' human will

The prayer 'not as I will, but as You will' led the early church to affirm that Christ has a human will fully submitted to the divine (Third Council of Constantinople, 681).

Three refrains, three courts?

The video links the three refrains of Psalms 42-43 to the temple's three areas. This is a suggestion; the psalms do not say it.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Luke's parallel to the warning is Luke 22:31-38, not Luke 21.
- Isaiah 38:1 shares the phrase 'to the point of death' (Hezekiah's illness); the closer echo of 'deeply grieved' is the refrain of Psalms 42-43.
- The quotation 'We tend to use prayer as a last resort…' is attributed to Oswald Chambers; the source was not checked here.
- The temple had more than three areas (courts of the Gentiles, women and Israel, the holy place and the holy of holies); 'three levels' is a simplification.

II · BACKGROUND

From the night of watching to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 26:30-46 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1446 BC DEBATED

A night to be kept for Yahweh

Exodus 12:42 *Echoed: 26:38*

C. 701 BC DEBATED

Hezekiah ill to the point of death

Isaiah 38:1

C. 520 BC DEBATED

Zechariah: strike the Shepherd

Zechariah 13:7 *Echoed: 26:31*

C. AD 30 DEBATED

The warning on the Mount of Olives

Matthew 26:30-35 *This episode*

C. AD 30 DEBATED

Gethsemane

Matthew 26:36-46 *This episode*

C. AD 62 DEBATED

Peter: be watchful

1 Peter 5:8

C. AD 390

Chrysostom: sleep overcame them

Matthew 26:40

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Hebrews 5:7-8
Prayers with loud crying and tears
ADDED

Luke 22:43-44
Sweat like drops of blood
ADDED

John 18:1
A garden across the Kidron
ADDED

John 10:17-18
I have authority to take it up again
ADDED

Romans 7:18-25
The struggle of the flesh
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ Why do you think all the disciples, not only Peter, vowed to die with Jesus?

2 ☐ What do Psalms 42-43 add to 'My soul is deeply grieved'?

3 ☐ How does Jesus' prayer in Gethsemane follow the Lord's Prayer?

4 ☐ Where in your life is 'the spirit willing, but the flesh weak'?

5 ☐ Is prayer your first line of defense or your last resort?

6 ☐ What one change would make your prayer more persistent and intentional?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: the victory of the Christian in moments of testing and temptation trades on persistent, intentional prayer to their heavenly Father. The disciples' words wrote checks their bodies could not cash. The flesh will fail; where the flesh fails, prayer succeeds. The teacher tells of being stuck in a hotel during a 2023 ice storm and being convicted that he prayed only after trying everything else; since then, he says, his prayer life has never been the same.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

pray the Lord's Prayer slowly each morning this week, pausing at 'Your will be done' and 'do not lead us into temptation' to name your specific situation.

> *"The victory of the Christian in moments of testing and temptation trades on persistent intentional prayer to their heavenly father.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Egypt ◆ Isaiah ◆ Holy Spirit ◆ Galilee ◆ Satan ◆ Temple (Jewish)
◆ Jerusalem ◆ Book of Psalms ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Gentiles
◆ James (son of Zebedee) ◆ John (son of Zebedee) ◆ Prayer ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Zebedee
◆ Daniel (the prophet) ◆ Paul ◆ Hezekiah ◆ Shepherd ◆ Passover ◆ Court of the Gentiles ◆ Cup
◆ Gethsemane ◆ Mount of Olives ◆ Resurrection ◆ Holy of holies ◆ Kidron Valley ◆ Temptation
◆ Wrath of God

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; Giovanni Bellini, National Gallery, London; public domain). Map: drawn for this study.

Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/bible-study/bible/matthew-52/